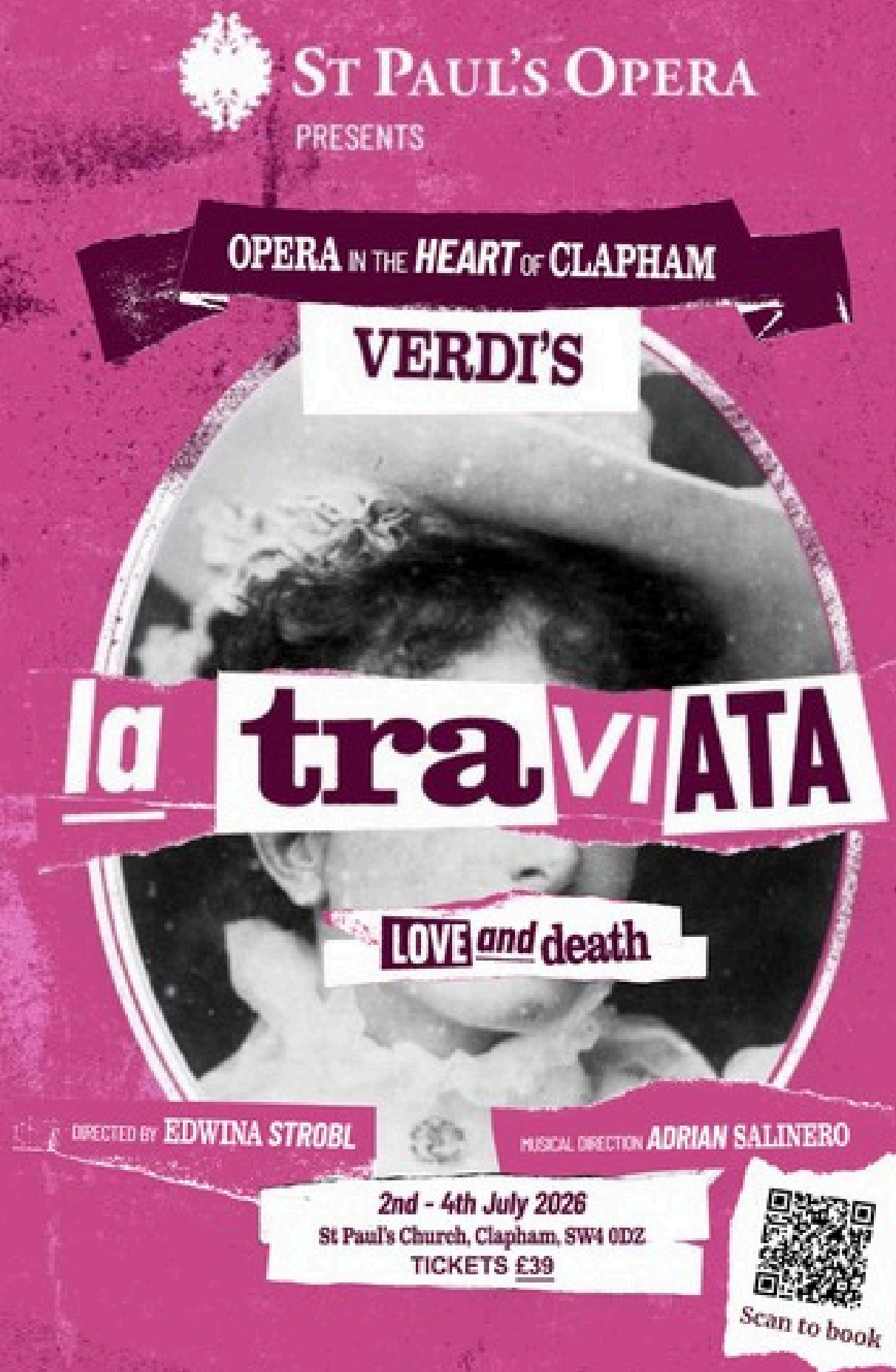




Presentation for Balance Physiotherapy

St Paul's Opera Summer Opera Festival 2026

The Trustees of St Paul's Opera would like to extend their thanks to Lucy Goldby, Victoria Chapman and the team at Balance Physiotherapy for their generosity and collaboration as our Community Partners in this year's Summer Opera Festival

The Production

We are delighted to say that over the course of this year's Summer Opera Festival, we welcomed nearly **700 people** through the doors of St Paul's Church to watch *La Traviata*! Our post-show survey showed that our audiences rated their likelihood of returning to another event at St Paul's Opera to be **95%**.

Nurturing our circle of supporters in the Clapham community is at the core of everything that we do, and presenting Balance Physiotherapy as our Community Partners has been an extremely positive relationship for us to showcase. Our two organisations share a joint vision of Clapham: a community that thrives on culture, quality experiences, high level performance, and good fun!

Our Singers

Our 2026 Summer Opera Festival production of Verdi's *La Traviata* was an overwhelming success - both for our audiences and for our team of emerging artists who gave such a wonderful show.

Throughout the production process, we provide training for our singers to develop their skills and gain valuable experience on the stage. This year, our singers received vocal coaching from **Susanna Stranders** (Royal Ballet & Opera), stagecraft coaching from star soprano **Alison Langer**, language coaching from Alessandra Fasolo (Royal Ballet & Opera), and regular mentoring from our Patron David Butt Philip. We were also able to develop a **training session** for our singers to prepare them to deliver educational workshops for children, enabling them to grow in confidence with this important skill in today's artistic landscape, and enriching the quality of the workshops for the children.

'A huge thank you to St Paul's Opera for giving me the opportunity to make my debut as Violetta, and to Tricia Ninian and the entire team for all the hard work, care and dedication that went into making this production so special.'

Lizzie Ryder - Violetta

'Alfredo has been a dream role for me for many years, so having the chance to try the role in a supportive environment where I could be coached on it was the best way to debut it. I'm pleased to say I've just been offered a role at Opera North!'

Christian Joel - Alfredo

St Paul's Opera Family Day

As part of our annual Summer Opera Festival, St Paul's Opera runs 'Family Day', a Saturday afternoon dedicated to children, with a relaxed matinée performance of our opera (this year, *La Traviata*) with added narration to increase accessibility, picnics and a long interval with activities for children.

In conjunction with our season, we run a Learning and Participation programme in local state primary schools, currently collaborating with five primary schools spanning Lambeth and Wandsworth boroughs. Families from these schools are offered free family tickets for Family Day, and *all* children attending receive free admission to Family Day.

Marketing and Communications:

Family Day is marketed firstly through our long-standing relationships with the primary schools with whom we collaborate (with direct comms inviting families to the event, following their children's participation in our workshops). Externally, we marketed Family Day through a feature on Nappy Valley, events on Wandsworth Council website, Nextdoor Events, and listings on several local parenting blogs such as Balham Babes and Hoop. (contd)

It is also marketed through our own direct comms channels, via newsletters and social media. Flyers for Family Day were also taken to primary schools that do not participate in our schools workshops, and to local child-friendly spaces (e.g. local play parks). It is important to us that as many local families as possible know about our offering and feel welcome.

On 4th July, we were delighted to welcome an eager audience of 138 people for Family Day. As well as the relaxed matinée performance and picnics, children were able to enjoy the following free activities:

Face-painting

Photobooth

Scavenger hunt with Prizes donated by Wicked Uncle Toys - (with all children receiving a prize)

Dressing up with punk costumes in the style of the production

The day culminated in a special moment of shared music-making, with the children joining in with the popular *Brindisi* chorus during the performance.

Our Audiences Said:

‘I thought it was St Pauls' best production yet’

‘What I particularly love is how very local it is. You all do an amazing job. The music has been playing in my head all weekend!’

‘SPO has been a wonderful introduction to opera. Beautiful singing, a warm welcome and in a glorious relaxed setting.’

‘the quality of the leading roles... all of them... were just superb! Comparable to any I’ve heard in Covent Garden.’

‘Our children from Macaulay were involved in the workshops and joined the chorus for the song in the show. They absolutely loved the whole experience. Thank you!’

‘Love the venue! Love the friendliness! Love the picnicing as part of the experience. Loved the staging! The cast was a perfect ensemble but one has to give a shout out for the Violetta. Glorious. Roll on 2027!’

‘A great performance and experience.’

The Critics Said:

‘There is no doubt that the whole company addressed the punk concept with engaging enthusiasm and wholesale vigour, but what made it work was Strobl's real eye for detail. Throughout, she made sure of her dramaturgy whether it be in the moment between the Barone (Ted Day) and Violetta (Lizzie Ryder) just before the Brindisi, or the way the entire scene between Germont (Owain Gwynfryn) and Violetta demonstrated the ever-present gulf between the two with no risk of getting mired in an added layer of sentimentality.

[...] the production successfully reinvented the work in a way that captured the imagination. And in this gusty and vivid performance we were involved from the word go.’

Planet Hugill

‘The company is to be congratulated for bringing their work to the community in this way. They are finding an audience for opera outside the mainstream and making the work truly accessible (there is even a special abbreviated show for families with children).’

London Theatre 1

‘St Paul’s Opera delivered an overwhelmingly powerful performance of Verdi’s La Traviata this Friday, replete with feeling and artistry. Directors Edwina Strobl and Adrian Salinero deserve an extra round of applause, for it is quite a challenge to handle a work of such magnitude with such finesse, especially on a modest budget. [...]

Pin Chen designed a line of bold outfits that paired beautifully with the riotous party and carnival scenes of 19th-century Paris, as well as with the high drama of a Romantic opera.’

A Youngish Perspective

Production Photos







Thank You!

The entire St Paul's Opera team is delighted to collaborate with Balance Physiotherapy. Self-improvement and high performance are core values of St Paul's Opera, and remain central to the work that we do with our brilliant young artists. We know that Balance shares in these values, and a partnership with you has been an ideal match for us as a pillar of the local arts scene in Clapham.

Thank you for supporting us to keep producing opera in the heart of Clapham!